Arcadio Macedo

Engineering Manager | PHP platforms | Technical leadership

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Professional profile

Engineering Manager combining people leadership with hands-on PHP engineering across compliance SaaS platforms. Lead eight direct reports in two multidisciplinary squads. Experience building teams, recovering legacy systems and implementing AI-assisted development. People-management responsibilities since 2019; Engineering Manager since January 2024.

Experience

Sphera (formerly Thinkstep)

November 2018 - Present | UK, remote

Engineering Manager

January 2024 - Present

- Lead eight direct reports in two squads, each with a Solutions Engineer, Build Manager, QA specialist and DevOps engineer. Coordinate priorities and the development lifecycle directly with the Product Owner.
- Screened, interviewed, hired and onboarded five of eight team members; continue their training and mentoring. Integrated an existing BOMcheck engineer and two newly assigned DevOps engineers.
- Established two squads for the company-led transition to an AI-oriented development lifecycle. Implement team guidance, context artefacts and guardrails around the central AI adoption team's Claude pipeline, from requirements and architecture through development, QA and release.
- Establish a high level of AI context readiness, supporting more accurate first-pass implementation and shorter delivery cycles, particularly for larger work items.
- Combine management with architectural decisions and hands-on implementation across BOMcheck and EC4P. Retained sole development responsibility for EC4P during the wider team's three-year focus on BOMcheck.
- Support structured performance improvement processes with management and HR, using clear expectations, coaching, regular feedback and progress reviews.
- Supported the move from Bitbucket to GitHub and Jira to Azure DevOps. Contribute to the ongoing programme preparing to migrate cloud infrastructure from AWS to Microsoft Azure.

Senior Software Engineer

November 2020 - December 2023

Assumed expanded team-building and engineering leadership responsibilities for BOMcheck in May 2023, leading its stabilisation and incremental modernisation before formal promotion to Engineering Manager.

Software Engineer

November 2018 - October 2020

Developed environmental compliance software. Took responsibility for a developer's onboarding, training, task guidance and performance review from approximately autumn 2019.

Selected engineering achievements

- **BOMcheck recovery** - Led stabilisation and incremental modernisation of a 19-year-old PHP monolith built on a custom framework, with minimal documentation and architectural knowledge concentrated in one engineer. Reverse-engineered critical behaviour and introduced Laravel to enable modular replacement of routing, authentication and application components.
- **Developer enablement and quality** - Resolved Windows repository compatibility issues and established local development environments, progressing through virtual machines and Docker to Laravel Herd. Built Bitbucket CI pipelines running PHPUnit, Pest and Selenium-based tests alongside PHPStan and code-quality checks.
- **APIs and platform integration** - Delivered API v2 supporting legacy IPC-1752A/B XML formats alongside JSON for customer PLM integrations. Modernised authentication and authorisation, integrated SpheraCloud SSO, and delivered a new single-page application and customer modules.
- **Payment continuity deadline** - Led and jointly implemented the migration from Opayo to Stripe with one engineer following notice of payment-service termination. Delivered an operational sandbox within five weeks and completed validation and production release within a further two weeks, meeting the deadline.
- **ESG reporting award** - Developed and implemented EC4P's Extended Producer Responsibility metrics dashboard in 2021. The dashboard was highlighted in Sphera's announcement of EC4P's Environment + Energy Leader Top Product of the Year award.

Earlier experience

Backend Developer, LOQBOX (October - November 2018); freelance software development through Developintech (2017 - 2018); Founder and Manager, Infomac (2013 - 2018), providing IT support, networking, technology solutions and computer repairs.

Technical skills

Engineering: PHP, Laravel, JavaScript, TypeScript, Vue, Vite, REST APIs, XML/JSON, MySQL, Redis.
Quality and delivery: PHPUnit, Pest, Selenium, Cypress, PHPStan, CI/CD, GitHub, Bitbucket, Azure DevOps.
Platform and integration: Docker, AWS, Nginx, SSO (SAML/OIDC), Stripe, logging and monitoring.
AI development: Claude-based workflows, context preparation, team guardrails and AI-assisted validation.

Education

Tecnologia em Análise e Desenvolvimento de Sistemas
Software Analysis and Development
Universidade Tecnológica Federal do Paraná (UTFPR), Brazil
2015 - 2018 | Graduated July 2018